

the Game Engine to access local, class and global game engine variables and class objects as well. As it runs on a Virtual Environment, there's no fear of Game Engine crashing.

Tools used

Famous Commercial Game Engines

- ▶ Id Software's DOOM, Quake Engine - FPS engine
- ▶ Epic games' Unreal Engine
- ▶ Microsoft's XNA framework – development platform for Xbox 360.
- ▶ Valve's source Engine – used in half-life and counter-strike.
- ▶ Torque Game Engine.
- ▶ Unity 3D

Open source game engines

- ▶ Panda 3D
- ▶ Yake (OGRE 3D) – Rendering Engine
- ▶ Blender Engine
- ▶ Irrlicht

Existing game engine versus writing your own

- ▶ Less development time required.
- ▶ Less testing and debugging.
- ▶ Many features directly available.
- ▶ Better focus on the game design.

Why to create a new engine

- ▶ No control over the implementation of features
- ▶ Adding features not yet in the game engine might be time consuming
- ▶ Dependent on other licensing scheme for release
- ▶ Other libraries/toolkits linked with the game engine (physics, AI...)
- ▶ A new Engine can be customized to your own needs.

Play testing

Play testing is set of techniques and methods that are used to collect relevant data and feedback about a player's experience with the game. Game Design play tests are used to analyze game usability; it's UI, balancing, level difficulty, mechanics, memory load, multi-player options etc. Play testing is different and harder than playing. There are several techniques